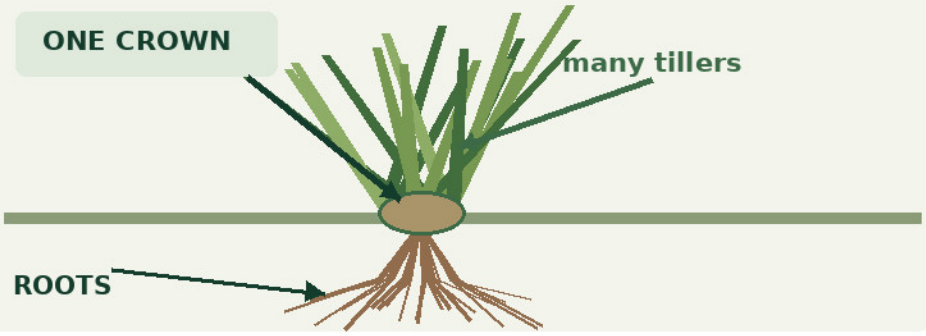
3. HOW GRASSES GROW

Look at the base: how do new shoots connect?

1 BUNCH / TUFT

Shoots cluster at one crown



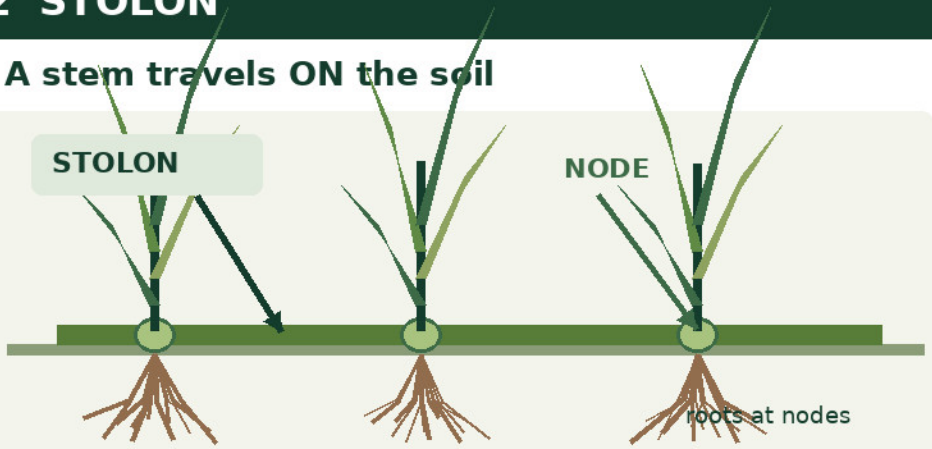
REAL SPECIES PHOTO



Little bluestem
Schizachyrium scoparium
TheMongrelKoi · CC0

2 STOLON

A stem travels ON the soil



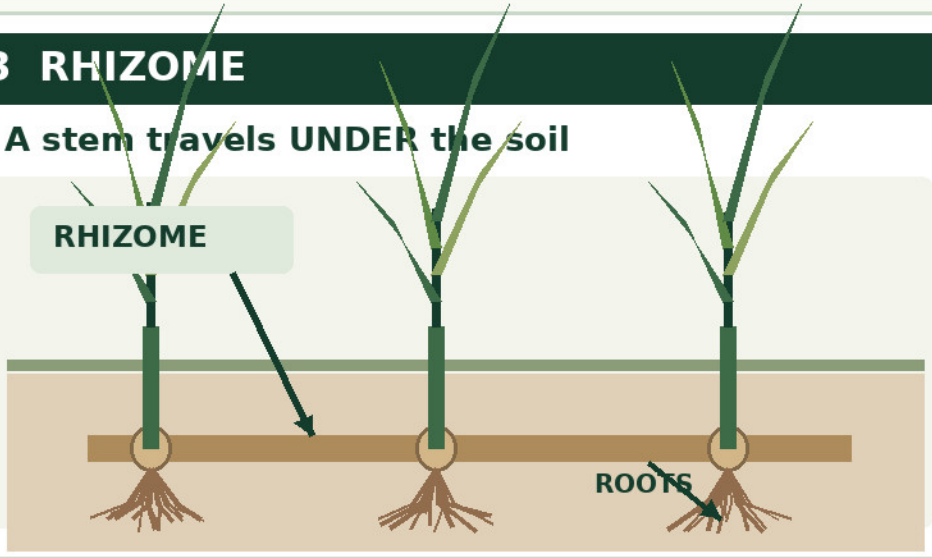
REAL SPECIES PHOTO



Bermudagrass
Cynodon dactylon
iNaturalist photo 410585094 · CC0

3 RHIZOME

A stem travels UNDER the soil



REAL SPECIES PHOTO



Johnsongrass
Sorghum halepense
Moadeeb · CC BY-SA 4.0

TRY IT

Trace the connected stem.

Above soil, below soil, or one crown?

Cutaway drawings are schematic. Bermudagrass makes BOTH stolons and rhizomes.